Αναφορα Πιλατου ∏ The Report of Pilate

Introduction

The *Report of Pontius Pilate* (aka the *Anaphora of Pilate*) is a report purportedly written by Pontius Pilate to Emperor Tiberius, detailing Jesus' miracles, crucifixion, and resurrection. The work is largely anti-Jewish: The miracles of Jesus are plain and obvious to Pilate as more powerful than any the Roman gods provide, yet the Jews blindly reject Jesus and demand his punishment, despite being unable to convict him of a single crime. Pilate only allows the execution to proceed to prevent a rebellion. After Jesus' death, a supernatural light comes down on Jerusalem at the third hour of the night; an earthquake opens the mountains, and the dead pour out from Hades; Jews who had dared speak against Jesus are swallowed by chasms from the earthquake, not even leaving bodies. All the synagogues in Jerusalem are destroyed except one.

The text survives in various early Greek recensions (dating from the 6th Century) and in some later Arabic manuscripts; the manuscripts in which it is found often contain other texts from the Pilate Cycle. The Greek text here presented is that of Constantine von Tischendorf's 'B' recension in his 1853 publication, *Evangelia Apocrypha*, with significant differences from his 'A' recension being noted; the English text is based on Alexander Walker's 1866 translation. The Arabic text here presented is that of *Codex Sinaiticus Arabic 445* (a 13th Century *MS*) and is taken from J.P. Monferrer Sala's 2009 publication[§], as is the translation thereof.

Authorship and Dates

The actual author of the work is not known. The report is dated by modern scholars to the late 5th Century, although early church writers, such as Tertullian, alluded to the existence of such a report (*circa* 197 CE).

§ Juan Pedro Monferrer Sala, in, "*The Anaphora Pilati According to the 'Sinaitic Arabic 445'*," Journal of Eastern Christian Studies, 61 (3–4), pp. 188–198. ***These texts are copyright © 2009, Journal of Eastern Christian Studies, and are reproduced here under licence from the publisher, De Gruyter Brill, according to the terms of the CC BY-SA-NC-ND agreement.***

Αναφορα Πιλατου – Πρόλογος

ΗΓΕΜΟΝΟΣ ΤΗΣ ΙΟΥΔΑΙΑΣ ΠΕΜΦΘΕΙΣΑ ΤΙΒΕΡΙΟ ΚΑΙΣΑΡΙ ΕΙΣ ΡΩΜΗΝ

Ἐν ἐκείναις ταῖς ἡμέραις σταυρωθέντος τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ ἐπὶ Ποντίου Πιλάτου ἡγεμόνος τῆς Παλαιστίνης καὶ τῆς Φοινίκης ταῦτα ἐν Ἱεροσολύμοις γέγονεν τὰ ὑπομνήματα τὰ κατὰ τοῦ κυρίου πραχθέντα ὑπὸ τῶν Ἰουδαίων. ὁ οὖν Πιλάτος μετ' οἰκείας αὐτοῦ ἀναφορᾶς ἐξέπεμψεν αὐτὰ τῷ Καίσαρι ἐν τῇ Ρώμῃ γράψας οὕτως.

Κρατίστῳ σεβαστῷ φοβερῷ θειοτάτῳ Αὐγούστῳ Πιλάτος Πόντιος ὁ τὴν ἀνατολικὴν διέπων ἀρχήν.

THE REPORT OF PILATE – PROLOGUE

SENT BY THE GOVERNOR OF JUDAEA TO TIBERIUS CAESAR IN ROME

[a] In those days, our Lord Jesus Christ having been crucified under Pontius Pilate, procurator of Palestine and Phoenicia, these records were made in Jerusalem as to what was done by the Jews against the Lord. Pilate, therefore, along with his private report, sent them to the Caesar in Rome, writing thus:

To the most mighty, venerable, awful, most divine, the August[b] –Pontius Pilate, the governor of the East:

مقدّمة

هذه تذكره ما فعل بربنا يسوع المسيح على عهد فيلاطس البنطي والي الهود

في سنه مانيه عسر من ملك طباريوس القيصر ملك الروم في تسعه عشر سنه من بداه ملك هيرودس بن هرودس ملك اليهود في خمسه وعشرين وما خلت من ادار في ولايه روفوا

وفى سنه اربعه من ولابنهم على عهد يوسيوس بن قيافا ريس كهنه الهود وكل ما كان بعد الصليب ومصايب الرب

This is an account of what was done to our Lord the Messiah during the age of Pontius Pilate, the governor of the Jews.

In the eighteenth year of the government of Tiberius Caesar, emperor of the Romans; in the nineteenth year from the beginning of the government of Herod, son of Herod, king of the Jews, when the twenty-fifth day of Adar had passed; during the consulate of Rufus, [c]

in the fourth year of his consulate; by command of Joseph, son of Caiaphas, the high priest of the Jews, and everything that happened after the

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ANAPHORA OF PILATE – PROLOGUE

[a] The 'B' recension does not include this paragraph, here following the 'A' recension.

[b] After '*August*', the 'A' recension adds '*Caesar*' (*Καίσαρι*).

[c] The paragraph break here, though seemingly unnatural, follows Monferrer Sala's transcription.

وفعال روس الكهنه وساير دلك من الهود حمع ما ابصر نقودمس كتبه بالعبرآنيه في تلك الايام صلب ايسوع بامر بيلاطس في ولاينه على فلسطين والساحل وهذه التدكره فعلت في بت المقدس من الهود بالمسح ورفعت الى طباريوس القصر في روميه قصه رفعها بيلاطس بسبب ربنا والاهنا يسوع المسح الى طباريوس القصر برومیه في تلك الايام عندما صلب ربنا يسوع المسيح بامر بيلاطس البنطي المتروس فلسطين والساحل كانت هذه التدكره بما فعلوا الهود بالرب ان بيلاطس رفع الى قيصر برومیه كاب فيه هكدا الى القوى المكرم المهاب طباريوس القيصر من بيلاطس من المشرق

crucifixion and the sufferings of the Lord and the doings of the leaders of the priests and the rest of those Jews. And everything Nicodemus saw was written in Hebrew. In those days, Jesus was crucified by command of Pilate, being governor of Palestine and of the coast. This is the account of what the Jews did to the Messiah in Jerusalem and it was presented to Tiberius Caesar in Rome. It was handed in by Pilate because of our Lord, our God Jesus the Messiah, to Tiberius Caesar in Rome in those days when Our Lord Jesus the Messiah was crucified by order of the wicked Pontius Pilate in Palestine and the coast. This account includes what the Jews did with the Lord that Pilate gave to Caesar in Rome. The document says thus: to the powerful, venerable and terrible Tiberius Caesar, from Pilate, of the East.

Αναφορα Πιλατου 1

Μηνῦσαι κέχρημαι πρὸς τὴν σὴν εὐσέβειαν διὰ τῆσδέ μου τῆς γραφῆς τρόμῳ πολλῷ καὶ φόβῳ συνεχόμενος, κράτιστε βασιλεῦ, τὴν τῶν ἐνισταμένων καιρῶν ῥοπήν, καθὼς τὸ τούτων τέλος ὑπέδειξε. Ταύτην γὰρ διέποντός μου τὴν ἐπαρχίαν, ὦ δέσποτα, κατὰ πρόσταξιν τῆς σῆς γαληνότητος, ἥτις ἐστὶ τῶν ἀνατολικῶν πόλεων μία καλουμένη Ἱερουσαλήμ, ἐν ᾗ τὸ ἱερὸν τοῦ τῶν Ἰουδαίων ἔθνους καθίδρυται, συναχθὲν ἅπαν τὸ πλῆθος τῶν Ἰουδαίων παραδεδώκασι μοι ἄνθρωπόν τινα λεγόμενον Ἰησοῦν, πολλὰ καὶ ἄπειρα ἐγκλήματα φέροντες κατ' αὐτοῦ· οὐκ ἠδυνήθησαν δὲ ἔν τινι λόγῳ ἐλέγξαι αὐτόν. μία δὲ αἵρεσις ἦν αὐτοῖς κατ' αὐτοῦ, ὅτι τὸ σάββατον ἔλεγεν μὴ εἶναι ὀρθὴν τούτων σχολήν. πολλὰς δὲ ἰάσεις ἐπετέλει ἐπ' ἀγαθοῖς ἔργοις ὁ ἄνθρωπος ἐκεῖνος· τυφλοὺς ἐποίησεν βλέπειν, λεπροὺς ἐκαθάρισεν, νεκροὺς ἤγειρε, παραλυτικοὺς ἰάσατο, μὴ δυναμένους τὸ σύνολον κινεῖσθαι, εἰ μὴ μόνον ἔχοντας φωνὴν καὶ τὴν τῶν ὀστέων ἁρμονίαν, καὶ παρέσχεν αὐτοῖς δύναμιν τοῦ περιπατεῖν τε καὶ τρέχειν, ῥήματι μόνῳ ἐπιτρέψας. ἄλλο τε δυνατώτερον πρᾶγμα ἐποίησεν, ὅπερ ἦν ξενὸν καὶ παρὰ τοῖς θεοῖς ἡμῶν· νεκρόν τινα Λάζαρον τετραήμερον ἐκ νεκρῶν ἀνέστησεν, λόγῳ μόνῳ κελεύσας ἐγερθῆναι τὸν τεθνεῶτα, διεφθαρμένον ἤδη ἔχοντα τὸ σῶμα ὑπὸ τῶν ἑλκογενήτων σκωλήκων· καὶ

THE REPORT OF PILATE 1

[a] I have to report to your reverence, through this writing of mine, being seized with great trembling and fear, O most mighty emperor, the conjuncture of the present times, as the end of these things has shown. For, while I, my lord, according to the commandment of your clemency, was discharging the duties of my government, which is one of the cities of the East, Jerusalem by name, in which is built the temple of the Jewish nation, all the multitude of the Jews came together, and delivered to me a certain man named Jesus, bringing against him many and groundless charges; and they were not able to convict him in anything. And one heresy of theirs against him was, that he said that the Sabbath was not their right rest. And that man wrought many cures, in addition to good works. He made the blind see; he cleansed lepers; he raised the dead; he healed paralytics who could not move at all, except that they only had their voice, and the joints of their bones; and he gave them the power of walking about and running, commanding them by a single word. And another mightier work he did, which was strange even with our gods: he raised up a dead man, Lazarus, who had been dead four days, by a single word ordering the dead man to be raised, although his body was already corrupted by the worms that grow in wounds; and that ill-smelling body lying in the

ANAPHORA OF PILATE 1

[a] The 'A' recension opens with, "*I have, O most mighty, a narrative to give you.*"

τὸ δυσῶδες ἐκεῖνο σῶμα τὸ κείμενον ἐν τῷ τάφῳ ἐκέλευσεν τρέχειν, καὶ ὡς ἐκ παστοῦ νυμφίος οὕτως ἐκ τοῦ τάφου ἐξῆλθεν εὐωδίας πλείστης πεπληρωμένος.

tomb he ordered to run; and, as a bridegroom from the bridal chamber, so he came forth out of the tomb, filled with a powerful fragrance. [a]

أ

اعاطيت ان اخبرك واا مرتعد ايه القوي ان في هده البلده التى ادبرها في بعض مدنها مدينه تقال لها اورشليم فيها جماعات لليهود وهم اسلموا الى رجلا بفال له يسوع قالين عليه ذنوب كثيره وما لم فدروا ان يثبتوها عليه وبعض ما كانوا يوحبوه عليه انه كان يبطل حفظ الست وكان يفعل شفاء كثير واعمال صالحه وذلك انه كان يصير العمى يصرون والمقعدن يمشون وموتا اقام ومخلعين ابرا الذي لم يكن لهم اصلا قوه جسد ولا عروف ثابته الا صوت ومفاصل ففط فوهب لهم قوه ان يمشون ويحرون وبكلمه واحده كان سفى الامراض فالذى هو اقوى من هدا واعجب انه اقام ميت له اربعة ايام في القبر دعاه من الموتا وقد نتن من القيح والدود في القبر فامره ان يحرى فحرا وليس فيه شي من اارات الموت ولكن كمل ختن من ححلته هكدا اخرح من القبر ممتلى روح طيب

I am going to tell you, while trembling because of the sign of the Almighty, as in this province that is under my rule, in one of its cities, a city called Jerusalem, where a crowd of Jews delivered to me a man called Jesus. They accused him of many faults that they could not prove against him. Some of them reproached him *that Jesus had said* [b] observing the Sabbath is nothing. He did many cures and good works: he made the blind see, the lame walk, raised the dead, cured the lepers, gave strength to those who had no strength at all [in their] body nor tension in their nerves – only voice and speech – for them to walk and run, and with only one word he cured sick people. And what is greater than all and more wonderful than this: he raised a dead man who had been four days in the grave, calling him from the dead, because he smelt badly due to the pus and the worms that were in the grave. He ordered him to run happily [c], as there were no traces of death in him, but he went out of the grave, like a groom from his bride chamber, full of perfumed fragrance.

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[a] Cf. Jn 11:1–44.

[b] Words presented in italics do not appear in the Arabic text but are either implied or required for clarity.

[c] Cf. Mt 11:43–44.

Αναφορα Πιλατου 2

Καί τινας ἀφειδώς δαιμονιζομένους καὶ τὰς οἰκήσεις ἔχοντας ἐν ἐρημίαις καὶ σαρκοφαγοῦντας τῶν ἰδίων μελῶν καὶ τοῖς ἑρπετοῖς καὶ τοῖς ἀγρίοις θηρίοις συναναστρεφομένους οἰκήτορας κατέστησεν πόλεων ἐν τοῖς ἰδίοις οἴκοις, καὶ διὰ λόγου σώφρονας αὐτοὺς ἀπέδειξε, καὶ συνετοὺς καὶ ἐνδόξους γενέσθαι παρεσκεύασεν τοὺς ὑπὸ ἀκαθάρτων πνευμάτων ἐνοχλουμένους, καὶ τοὺς ἐν αὐτοῖς δαίμονας ἐν ἀγέλη χοίρων ἐκπέμψας εἰς θάλασσαν ἀπέπνιξεν.

THE REPORT OF PILATE 2

[a] And some that were cruelly vexed by demons, and had their dwellings in deserts, and ate the flesh of their own limbs, and lived along with reptiles and wild beasts, he made to be dwellers in cities in their own houses, and by a word he rendered them sound-minded; and he made those that were troubled by unclean spirits to be intelligent and reputable; and, sending away the demons in them into a herd of swine, he suffocated them in the sea. [b]

ب

وبالحقيقة مخابين كان مساكنهم في الرارى وياكلون لحومهم ويترددون مع السباع والدااات صرهم اعفا وعقلا وحكما والارواح النجسه الى كانت قالهم وهى فهم مهلكه لهم رما بها الى عمق البحر

Verily, some wretches who dwelt in the desert and ate their *own*[c] flesh, moving like beasts and reptiles, he turned them into honest, sensible and wise people, and the filthy spirits which spoke and lived in them *while* annihilating them he threw them to the depths of the sea.

ANAPHORA OF PILATE 2

[a] The ‘A’ recension has a very similar text for this chapter.

[b] Cf. Mt 8:28–34, Mk 5:1–20, Lk 8:26–39.

[c] Words presented in italics (Monferrer Sala has them in brackets) do not appear in the Arabic text but are either implied or required for clarity.

Αναφορα Πιλατου 3

Ἄλλον πάλιν τινὰ ξηρὰν ἔχοντα τὴν χεῖρα καὶ ἐν λύπαις ζῶντα καὶ μηδὲ ἥμισυ σώματος ἔχοντα ὑγιές λόγῳ μόνῳ παρέστησεν ὑγιῆ.

THE REPORT OF PILATE 3

[a] Another man, again, who had a withered hand, and lived in sorrow, and had not even half of his body sound, he made sound by a single word. [b]

ت

واصا رجل اخر كانت ده ياسه وصف حسده ايضا كان قد يبس بكلمته اشقاه وخلاه صحيحا

There was also another man who had a dry hand and the half of his body was also dry, and he cured him and made him healthy with one word.

ANAPHORA OF PILATE 3

[a] The ‘A’ recension has a longer text for this verse, but the overall sense is the same: *Πάλιν δὲ ἄλλος ὑπῆρχεν ξηρὰν ἔχων τὴν χεῖραν, οὐ μόνον δὲ τὴν χεῖραν, ἀλλὰ μᾶλλον τὸ ἥμισυ μέρος τοῦ σώματος ἀπολιθωθὲν ὑπῆρχεν τοῦ ἀνθρώπου, μήτε πλάσιν ἀνδρὸς ἢ σώματος ἔχων διαστολήν· κἀκεῖνον λόγῳ ἰάσατο καὶ ὑγιῆ ἀπέδειξεν.* (*And again, there was another having a withered hand; and not the hand only, but rather the half of the body of the man, was petrified, so that he had not the form of a man, or the power of moving his body. And him, by a word, he healed and made sound.*)

[b] Cf. Mt 12:9–14, Mk 3:1–6, Lk 6:6–11.

Αναφορα Πιλατου 4

Καὶ γυναῖκα αἱμορροοῦσαν ἐπὶ χρόνοις πολλοῖς, ὡς ἐξ αὐτῆς τῆς ῥύσεως τοῦ αἵματος πᾶσαν τὴν τῶν ὀστέων ἁρμονίαν φαίνεσθαι καὶ ὑέλου δίκην διαυγάζειν, καὶ γὰρ πάντες ἰατροὶ ἀνελπίστως αὐτὴν ἀπειπάμενοι οὐκ ἐκαθαίρουν· οὐκ ἦν γὰρ ἐν αὐτῇ δήπου τις σωτηρίας ἐλπίς· ποτέ γ᾽ οὖν παρερχομένου τοῦ Ἰησοῦ ἥψατο ὄπισθεν τοῦ κρασπέδου τῶν ἱματίων αὐτοῦ, καὶ αὐτῇ τῇ ὥρᾳ ἀνεπληρώθη ἡ δύναμις τοῦ σώματος αὐτῆς, καὶ γέγονεν ὑγιὴς ὡς μηδὲν κακὸν ἔχουσα, καὶ ἤρξατο δρομαίως τρέχειν εἰς τὴν αὐτῆς πόλιν Πανεάδα.

THE REPORT OF PILATE 4

And a woman that had a flow of blood for many years, so that, in consequence of the flowing of her blood, all the joints of her bones appeared, and were transparent like glass; and, assuredly, all the physicians had left her without hope, and had not cleansed her; for, there was not in her a single hope of health; once, then, as Jesus was passing by, she took hold of the fringe of his clothes behind, and that same hour the power of her body was completely restored, and she became whole, as if nothing were the matter with her, and she began to run swiftly to her own city Paneas[a].

ث

وامراه ايضا تنزف الدم وقد انحلت عروقها ومفاصلها من نزف الدم حتى انها ليس كانت تحمل جسد انسى بل كانت تسبه الموتا الدن ليس لهم صوت ولم كن استطاع احد من الاطبا الدين في البلدان يشفوها لانه لم يكون بقى فيها رجا حياه فتحرت ويسوع جايز احدت قوه وبن الخلق امسكت طرف توبه ومن ساعها انقوت وبريت وبدات تجرى الي مدنها بانياس من كفرنخوم وكان دلك منها عير قريب مسره سته ايام

There was also a haemorrhaging woman, whose veins and arteries were ruined by the haemorrhage to the point that she did not wear a human body, but she looked like the dead who have no voice. None of the physicians of the region could cure her, and she did not have any life expectancy. While Jesus was just passing, she crawled and making a supreme effort she held on to the border of his garment among the people. [b] At once, she started to feel a great strength and was cured and she began to run as quickly as possible towards her city, Capernaum. And that was far, a journey of six days.

ANAPHORA OF PILATE 4

[a] For the name of this city (‘*Paneas*’ – *Πανεάδα*) the ‘A’ recension has ‘*Capernaum*’ (*Κεφαρναούμ*) – see also the Arabic text.

[b] Cf. *Acts of Pilate*, Ch. 7.

Αναφορα Πιλατου 5

Καὶ ταῦτα μὲν οὕτως εἶχον· κατεμήνυον δὲ οἱ Ἰουδαίοι ἐκτελεῖν ταῦτα ἐν σαββάτῳ τὸν Ἰησοῦν. ἐγὼ δὲ καὶ παρὰ τοὺς θεοὺς οὓς σεβόμεθα μείζονα κατενόησα θαυμάσια παρ' αὐτοῦ γεγονότα.

THE REPORT OF PILATE 5

[a] And these things indeed were so. And the Jews gave information that Jesus did these things on the Sabbath. And I also ascertained that the miracles done by him were greater than any that the gods whom we worship could do.

ج

واضا رجل اخر ولد اعما من بطن امه ولم يكن له عينين
اصلا فبزق على الارض وجعل طين ولطح موضع عينيه
وخلق له عينين يبصر بهما وارسله الي ما سلوان يعسل به
وفى السبت كان ايسوع يعمل اعاجيب افضل من هذه حتى
باني قد فهمت من عجايه اكثر ما فعلت الهتنا الى نعبدها

And there was another man, who was born blind and had no eyes. *Jesus* spat on the ground, took clay, and anointed the place of his eyes. He gave him two eyes to see and sent him to the *pool of* Siloam to wash in it. [b] On the Sabbath, Jesus made miracles even greater than those, so, I think that his miracles are greater than those done by our gods whom we worship.

ANAPHORA OF PILATE 5

[a] The 'A' recension has a slightly different text for this chapter: *Καὶ ταῦτα μέν, ἃ προσφάτως κατὰ νοῦν ἔχων ἐμήνυσα, ἅπερ ἐν σαββάτῳ ἐτέλεσεν ὁ Ἰησοῦς· καὶ ἕτερα μείζονα τούτων ἐποίησε σημεῖα, ὡς ὅτι καὶ παρὰ τοὺς θεοὺς οὓς σεβόμεθα μείζονα κατενόησα θαυματουργήματα παρ' αὐτοῦ γεγονότα.* (*And these are the things that I lately had in my mind to report, which Jesus accomplished on the Sabbath. And other signs greater than these he did, so that I have perceived that the wonderful works done by him are greater than can be done by the gods whom we worship.*)

[b] Cf. Jn 9:1–7.

Αναφορα Πιλατου 6

Τοῦτον οὖν Ἡρώδης καὶ Ἀρχέλαος καὶ Φίλιππος καὶ Ἄννας καὶ Καϊάφας παραδεδώκασι μοι σὺν παντὶ τῷ λαῷ πρὸς τὸ ἐτάσαι αὐτόν. καὶ πολλῶν στάσιν κινησάντων κατ' ἐμοῦ, ἐκέλευσα σταυρωθῆναι.

THE REPORT OF PILATE 6

Him then Herod and Archelaus and Philip, and Annas and Caiaphas, with all the people, delivered to me to try him. And, as many were exciting an insurrection against me, I ordered him to be crucified[a].

ج

فلهذا هيرودس وارشلاوس وفيلبس وانيس وقيافا مع جمع الشعب اسلموه الى لكيما يهلكوه فعندما حركوا على الشعب شغب كتير امرت ان يصلب بعد ان ضربته بالسياط ولم اصب عليه علة فعال سوًا

For this, Herod, Archelaus, Philip, Annas, and Caiaphas, with the people, delivered him to me for them to kill him. And, when they incited the people, there was a great turmoil and I ordered him to be crucified after he was whipped, without there being any single reason *or*[b] wrongdoing against him.

ANAPHORA OF PILATE 6

[a] The 'A' recension adds, "*having first scourged him, and having found against him no cause of evil accusations or deeds.*" (*πρῶτον φραγελλώσας αὐτόν, καὶ μηδεμίαν αἰτίαν εὑρὼν κατ' αὐτοῦ κακῶν ἐγκλημάτων ἢ πράξεων*)

[b] Words presented in italics (*Monferrer Sala* has them in brackets) do not appear in the Arabic text but are either implied or required for clarity.

Αναφορα Πιλατου 7

Ἡνίκα δὲ ἐσταυρώθη, σκότος ἐγένετο ἐφ' ὅλην τὴν οἰκουμένην, τοῦ ἡλίου κρυβέντος τελείως καὶ τοῦ πόλου σκοτεινοῦ φαινομένου ἡμέρας οὔσης, ὥστε ἄστρα φανῆναι ἀλλ' ὅμως τὴν τηλαυγότητα ἐσκοτισμένην ἔχειν, ὡς οὐδὲ ἡ ὑμετέρα οἶμαι εὐσέβεια ἀγνοεῖ, ὅτι ἐν παντὶ τῷ κόσμῳ ἥψαν λύχνους ἀπὸ ἕκτης ὥρας ἕως ὀψίας. σελήνη δὲ ὡς αἷμα οὖσα ὅλην τὴν νύκτα οὐ διέλαμπε, καίτοι γε παμπληθοῦς αὐτῆς τυγχανούσης. τὰ ἄστρα δὲ καὶ ὁ Ὠρίων θρῆνον ἐποίουν περὶ τῶν Ἰουδαίων διὰ τὴν παρ' αὐτῶν γενομένην παρανομίαν.

THE REPORT OF PILATE 7

And, when he had been crucified, there was darkness over the whole earth, the sun having been completely hidden, and the heaven appearing dark though it was day, so that the stars appeared, but had at the same time their brightness darkened, as I suppose your reverence is not ignorant of, because in all the world they lit lamps from the sixth hour until evening. And the moon, being like blood, did not shine the whole night, and yet she happened to be at the full. And the stars also, and Orion[a], made a lament about the Jews, on account of the wickedness that had been done by them.

خ

فلما صلب صارت ظلمه علي الدنيا كلها واظلمت الشمس نصف النهار والكواكب لم تظهر شعاعها والقمر انكشفت وصار صوه مثل الدم وكدلك ستر هيكل اليهود اشق ومن شده الزلزله انسقفت الصخور

When he was crucified, darkness fell over the whole earth, the sun was darkened at midday, the stars did not shine, the moon was uncovered and her light appeared like blood. Likewise, the veil of the temple of the Jews was torn up, and due to a strong quake the rocks were cracked.[b]

ANAPHORA OF PILATE 7

[a] The 'A' recension does not mention the '*moon*' or '*Orion*'.

[b] Cf. Mt 27:51, Mk 15:38, Lk 23:44–45.

Αναφορα Πιλατου 8

Μιᾷ δὲ τῶν σαββάτων περὶ τρίτην ὥραν τῆς νυκτὸς ὁ ἥλιος ὤφθη οἷος οὐδέποτε ἔλαμψεν, καὶ πᾶς ὁ οὐρανὸς ἐφαιδρύνθη. καὶ ὡς ἀστραπαι χειμῶνος ἐπέρχονται, οὕτως ἄνδρες ὑψηλοί τινες κοσμήσεως στολῆς καὶ δόξης ἀνεκδιηγήτου ὑπάρχοντες ἐφαίνοντο ἐν τῷ ἀέρι, καὶ πλῆθος ἀναρίθμητον ἀγγέλων κραζόντων καὶ λεγόντων Δόξα ἐν ὑψίστοις θεῷ καὶ ἐπὶ γῆς εἰρήνη, ἐν ἀνθρώποις εὐδοκία· ἀνέλθατε ἐξ ᾅδου, οἱ δεδουλωμένοι ἐν τοῖς καταχθονίοις τοῦ ᾅδου. ἐκ δὲ τῆς φωνῆς αὐτῶν πάντα τὰ ὄρη καὶ οἱ βουνοὶ ἐσαλεύοντο και πέτραι διερρήγνυντο καὶ χάσματα ἐγένοντο μεγάλα ἐν τῇ γῇ, ὥστε καὶ τὰ τῆς ἀβύσσου φανῆναι.

THE REPORT OF PILATE 8

[a] And, on the first of the week, about the third hour of the night, the sun was seen such as it had never at any time shone, and all the heaven was lit up. And, as lightnings come on in winter, so majestic men of indescribable splendour of dress and of glory appeared in the air, and an innumerable multitude of angels crying out, and saying, "Glory in the highest to God, and on earth peace, among men goodwill. Come up out of Hades, you who have been kept in slavery in the underground regions of Hades." And, at their voice, all the mountains and hills were shaken, and the rocks were burst asunder; and great chasms were made in the earth, so that also what was in the abyss appeared.

د

وظهروا الموتى فى دلك الفزع وقاموا كما شهدوا الهود انهم نطروا الى ابرهيم واسحق وعقوب الابا وموسى وايوب الذين ماتوا كما قالوا اوليك من الفن سنه و خمس

[b] In the middle of this terror the dead, who had risen, appeared, as even the Jews testify that they saw Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, the Fathers, and Moses, and Job who died (as they say) two thousand five hundred years

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ANAPHORA OF PILATE 8

[a] The 'A' recension has a rather different text for this chapter: *Ὤφθησαν δὲ ἐν αὐτῷ τῷ φόβῳ νεκροὶ ἀναστάντες, ὡς αὐτοὶ οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι ἐμαρτύρησαν, καὶ εἶπον εἶναι Ἀβραὰμ καὶ Ἰσαὰκ καὶ Ἰακώβ καὶ τοὺς δώδεκα πατριάρχας καὶ Μωσῆν καὶ Ἰώβ, τοὺς προτετελευτηκότας ὥς φασιν ἐκεῖνοι πρὸ τρισχιλίων πεντακοσίων ἐτῶν· καὶ πλεῖστοι πολλοὶ οὓς κἀγὼ εἶδον ἐν σώματι φανέντας, καὶ θρῆνον δὲ ἐποίουν περὶ τῶν Ἰουδαίων διὰ τὴν γενομένην δι' αὐτῶν παρανομίαν καὶ ἀπώλειαν τῶν Ἰουδαίων καὶ τοῦ νόμου αὐτῶν.* (*And, in that terror, dead men were seen that had risen, as the Jews themselves testified; and they said that it was Abraham, and Isaac, and Jacob, and the twelve patriarchs, and Moses and Job, that had died, as they say, three thousand five hundred years before. And there were very many whom I also saw appearing in the body; and they were making a lamentation about the Jews, on account of the wickedness that had come to pass through them, and the destruction of the Jews and of their law.*)

[b] As often in the work, the Arabic text closely reflects the Greek 'A' recension.

مايه سنه وا ا ايضا راينا كرين طهروا في الاحساد وناحوا نوحا كتير لما صنع بيسوع من الفعل القطيع وهلاك امه اليهود وناموسهم

ago. I also saw many who appeared in *their* body, while they were really moaning because of the vexation that was done with Jesus and because of the destruction of the Jewish community and of their Law.

Αναφορα Πιλατου 9

Ὤφθησαν δὲ ἐν αὐτῷ τῷ φόβῳ νεκροὶ ἀναστάντες, ὡς αὐτοὶ ἑωρακότες οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι εἶπον ὅτι εἴδομεν Ἀβραὰμ καὶ Ἰσαὰκ καὶ Ἰακὼβ καὶ τοὺς δώδεκα πατριάρχας τοὺς προτετελευτηκότας πρὸ δισχιλίων πεντακοσίων ἐτῶν, καὶ Νῶε εἴδομεν ἐν σώματι φανερῶς. καὶ περιεπάτει πᾶν πλῆθος καὶ ἀνυμνει τὸν θεόν μετά φωνῆς μεγάλης λέγων Ὁ ἀναστὰς ἐκ τῶν νεκρῶν κύριος ὁ θεὸς ἡμῶν πάντας τοὺς νεκροὺς ἐζωοποίησεν, καὶ τὸν ᾅδην συλήσας ἐνέκρωσε.

THE REPORT OF PILATE 9

[a] And there were seen in that terror dead men raised up, as the Jews that saw them said, "We have seen Abraham, and Isaac, and Jacob, and the twelve patriarchs, that died two thousand five hundred years ago; and we have seen Noah manifestly in the body." And all the multitude walked about, and sang praises to God with aloud voice, saying, "The Lord our God who has risen from the dead has brought to life all the dead, and has plundered Hades, and put him to death."

ذ

ولم يهدا الخوف من ست ساعات يوم الجمعة الي عشبه السبت وعشيه سبت صباح الاحد صرخ صوت من السما واضت السما اكثر من كل الايام سبعه اصعاف فى له ساعات من الليل وظهرت الشمس مضيه في كل السما وكمثل برق الشتا كدلك طهروا رجال عظما بلباس بهى وتسبحه عظيمه وهم كتير لا تحصوا صالحن وكانت أصواتهم عاليات مثل الرعد العظيم الاله الدى صلب قد قام اصعدوا من الححيم يايه المستعبدين فى اسفل الارض وانسقت الارض حتى انه لم كن لها ثبات وهكدا ظهرت امياه العمق مع صياح الدين كاوا في السما وكانوا الموتا الدن قامو كتره كثيره يمشون وانه سلب الححيم مواه وطهر للنسوه وقال لهم قولوا للللاميد ان قدموني الى الجليل لانهم ثمه سايروني

For this, the terror was from the sixth hour on Friday until Saturday evening. And *after* Saturday evening, on Sunday morning a voice from heaven was heard. The sky[b] was shining seven times more than usual.[c] At the third hour of the night, the sun appeared shining in the whole sky; it was like winter lightning. Likewise, some impressive men appeared with beautiful clothes and a great glory while shouting (they were innumerable). Their voices were powerful, as the great thunder, "God, who was crucified, has already risen from the dead. Go up from hell those who are enslaved in the depths of the earth!" The earth was cracked, destroying the foundations *of the earth* and thus the waters of the abyss appeared with the cries of those who were in heaven, whereas the dead who had risen (a great crowd) wandered. He took his dead out of hell and appeared to the women and he said to them, "Say to the disciples that they are to go before me into Galilee, for there they shall see me."

ANAPHORA OF PILATE 9

[a] Compare the 1st part of this chapter with Ch. 8 of the 'A' recension.

[b] Monferrer Sala has '*heaven*' in place of '*sky*'.

[c] The seven-times-more-powerful light is a well-known apocalyptic-eschatological figure in Oriental Christian works.

Αναφορα Πιλατου 10

Πᾶσαν οὖν τὴν νύκτα ἐκείνην, ὡ δέσποτα βασιλεῦ, τὸ φῶς οὐκ ἐπαύετο. τῶν δὲ Ἰουδαίων πολλοὶ ἀπέθανον καὶ κατεποντίσθησαν καὶ κατεπόθησαν τοῖς χάσμασιν ἐν τῇ νυκτὶ ἐκείνῃ, ὥστε μηδὲ τὰ σώματα αὐτῶν φανῆναι· ἐκείνους δὲ λέγω παθεῖν τῶν Ἰουδαίων τοὺς κατὰ τοῦ Ἰησοῦ λέγοντας. μία δὲ συναγωγὴ κατελείφθη ἐν Ἱεροσολύμοις, ἐπεὶ πᾶσαι αἱ συναγωγαὶ ἐκεῖναι αἱ γενόμεναι κατὰ τοῦ Ἰησοῦ κατεποντίσθησαν.

THE REPORT OF PILATE 10

[a] All that night, therefore, my lord, O king, the light did not cease. And many of the Jews died and were engulfed and swallowed up in the chasms that night, so that not even their bodies appeared. Those, I say, of the Jews suffered that had spoken against Jesus. And one synagogue was left in Jerusalem, since all those synagogues that had been against Jesus were engulfed.

ر

وكل لك الليله لم زل الضو طاهرا وكرن من اليهود ماتوا في هوته لك الارض وابتلعوا حتى ان كتيرن لم يجدوا للغد ممن فعل بسوع ما فعل وان محامع اليهود في اورسليم فروا ولم طهر منهم احدا

During all that night, the light did not cease to shine, and many of the Jews died in a fissure of the earth and they split their heads open. Many of those who did as they did to Jesus were not found in the morning, and the synagogues[b] of the Jews of Jerusalem fled and no one of them appeared.

ANAPHORA OF PILATE 10

[a] The ‘A’ recension has similar text for this chapter.

[b] Here, the term, ‘*synagogues*’, refers to the people attending them.

Αναφορα Πιλατου 11

Τῷ οὖν φόβῳ ἐν ἐκστάσει γενόμενος καὶ πολλῷ τρόμῳ συσχεθείς κατ' αὐτὴν τὴν ὥραν ἐπιτάξας γράψαι τὰ πραχθέντα παρ' αὐτῶν πάντων ἀνήγαγον τῷ σῷ κράτει.

THE REPORT OF PILATE 11

[a] From that fear, then, being perplexed and seized with much trembling, at that same hour I ordered what had been done by them all to be written; and I have reported it to your mightiness.

ز

فلما رايت هذه الاشيا المفرعه وبهتت بنفسى رفعت الى قوتك فسرت لك حميع ما فعلوا اليهود يسوع وبعثت الى ملكك

When seeing these terrible things, I was stunned. I have submitted before your power and explained to you everything that the Jews did to Jesus, and I have referred it to your authority. It was finished.

ANAPHORA OF PILATE 11

[a] The 'A' recension has a similar but slightly longer text for this chapter: *Τῷ οὖν φόβῳ ἐκείνῳ ἐν ἐκστάσει γενόμενος καὶ τρόμῳ δεινοτάτῳ συνεχόμενος, ἅπερ εἶδον κατ' αὐτὴν τὴν ὥραν γράψας ἀνήγαγον τῷ σῷ κράτει· ἐντάξας καὶ τὰ κατὰ τοῦ Ἰησοῦ πραχθέντα ὑπὸ τῶν Ἰουδαίων ἐξέπεμψα τῇ σῇ θειότητι, δέσποτα.* (*With that terror, being in perplexity, and seized with a most frightful trembling, I have written what I saw at that time and have reported to your majesty. Having set in order also what was done by the Jews against Jesus, I have sent it, my lord, to your divinity.*)